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MY THOUGHTS SHARED

September 3, 2013

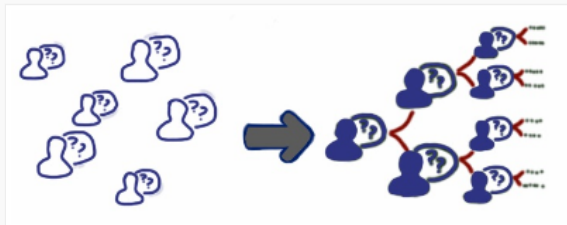


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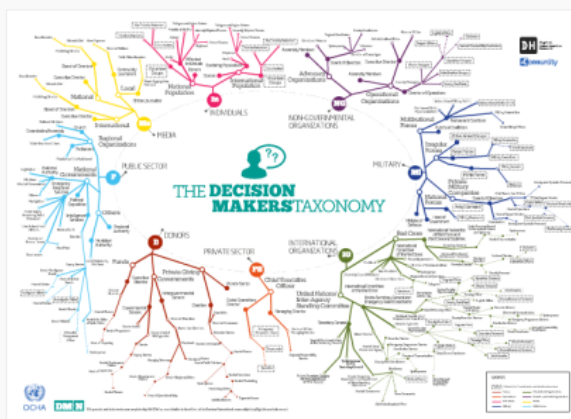
These are the Humanitarian Decision Makers

In my June post *Who are the Humanitarian Decision Makers*, I outlined why I have problems with how easily we use the phrase “for the decision makers” without really knowing who they are. Once you start investigating the problem, you quickly realize how large and diverse the range of decision makers are in humanitarian response.



Now, it is easy to complain but harder to do something. So rather than leaving this problem to fester within the community, a few of us decided to do something. A first outcome of that work is version one of the Humanitarian Decision Makers Taxonomy ([offline PDF full size](#) | [offline PDF A3 size](#) | [online interactive](#)).

We hope that from now on, this product will help people to have more structured conversations, to be able to better articulate which decision makers they are targeting, to inquire with said people to design better products, and to continue expanding (openly) on this work.



A huge amount of credit goes out to [Quentin Nicaise](#) who did the bulk of the work putting this piece together and developing the [interactive version](#). Full credit to [Ana Macau](#) who designed the offline version. And to [Jarrod Goentzel](#), [Bartel Van de Walle](#), [Erica Gralla](#) and [Lars Peter Nissen](#) for their keen interest and participation in the DMN Community as well as planting the seed for the taxonomy.

The taxonomy and related work was completed by UN-OCHA as a contribution to the Decision Makers Need (DMN) Community who released it under a Creative Commons attribution license. Hopefully this means that we will see it be used for a range of purposes.

My story



I am a disaster responder and information management officer for UN-OCHA. I have a passion for simple and sometimes even seemingly childish innovative new concepts. I want people to collaborate with me to find the best solutions, new ideas, problems with my logic, and new bits that make my ideas work. I want to put my pieces on the table and start working. I do not believe that I have brilliant ideas, but rather I want to discover them.

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The data to complete the taxonomy has also been released so that you can recompile or restructure how you want. We envision that several more things could be done with this data to help the community - categorize decision maker types (strategic, tactical, operational, etc), group similar role types, group by geographical coverage, etc. If you have an idea, feel free to give it a try and share it back.

If you are interested in getting involved with the DMN Community, kindly see their page on the Digital Humanitarian Network website.

Andrej

Are you subscribed by email?

Filed under decision makers



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Andrea Hoplight Tapia

10 years ago

Wow. Great Stuff here. Blowing up the infographic to show my students. Thanks!

24

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Flávio Horita

10 years ago

Great work, Andrej! Congrats!

I started my research few months ago and its the first step, it is to answer these questions (e.g. what are the decisions? what is the information need? etc.).

Certainly, this taxonomy will be useful but I am curious, do you have some draft showing all issues related with decision-making process? We meet some of them: decision, decision maker, affected population, information needed, there aren't more? So, which are the elements or actors associated with decision-making process?

Thanks.

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Andrej Verity

Mod

10 years ago

→ Flávio Horita

Hi Flavio,

Nothing document quite like you want (I think). We ran a workshop a while back with seasoned international humanitarian responders (for sudden on-set emergencies) where they articulated many of the main decisions that they have to make and the information they need. I am hoping that the report will come out soon - we are just waiting on a final editorial review. It will still come out quite raw - we want to share as much of the detail from the workshop with the community so that anyone can perform their own analysis.

Andrej

see more

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Willow Brugh

10 years ago

Great stuff, and thank you!

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Hi Willow.

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Charlotte Lattimer

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Hi Charlotte,

Andrej

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Mod



10 years ago

Hi Dan